GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

March 13th, 2026
Week 11
Volume 282, Issue 1226

Highlights:

- **Tensions lift oil.**
- **Freight follows oil.**
- **Shipping routes tighten.**
- **Markets turn volatile.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Success is the sum of small efforts, repeated day-in and day-out."

–Robert Collier

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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Turbulent Tides!

Escalating tensions in the Middle East ran through global markets again this week, as military activity near Iran's Kharg Island, the country's primary oil export terminal that can host up to 10 supertankers at a time, unsettled already fragile energy markets and pushed oil prices that currently linger around USD 100/ton even higher. Developments around the terminal quickly drew market attention as traders reacted to potential disruptions in regional supply flows, while movements in oil prices began to ripple across shipping markets and broader economic indicators. As oil started to climb, freight followed suit, continuing to feed the already rising global inflation picture, while the U.S. Dollar wore the crown jewel of the week, rising notably against all of the major international ship recycling markets. At the same time, local steel plate prices saw another volatile week across several recycling destinations as currency fluctuations and domestic demand influenced pricing levels across the Subcontinent.

As the situation developed, additional maritime security measures were introduced across key transit routes in the region to help ensure the safe passage of commercial traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. Given that this corridor remains one of the most critical shipping arteries for global crude flows, even the perception of instability quickly translates into stronger oil prices, firmer freight sentiment, and renewed uncertainty across shipping markets.

International markets overall are expected to remain unsettled while tensions continue across the Middle East. Surging fuel prices across most regions are already beginning to lower freight incomes on a wide range of vessels, while security concerns have also increased following reported incidents involving commercial ships this past week, alongside continued warnings directed at vessels operating nearby. Quick stats before we run out of space? Oil closed roughly 3% higher than last week at USD 98/barrel and is expected to remain volatile should tensions escalate further, while the Baltic Exchange Dry Index rose nearly 3% as well, fueled by the Cape (up 5.8%), Panas (up 0.2%), while smaller indices moved lower (down 0.5%).

Behind the broader market volatility lies a challenging reality: assets under pressure, currencies depreciating, and businesses across several sectors facing tighter operating margins as higher energy costs ripple through the global economy. Trickling down, recycling markets are again facing fluctuating currency rates and unsettled recyclers, while rumors of anticipated shortages of fuel and gas continue to add to industry uncertainty.

Incredibly, some sales were still confirmed during the week as MISC continued their clear-out of older units via 3x LNG tankers, alongside a few Capesize bulkers reported on private terms, as well as several Handymax bulkers from various owners. Bangladesh has once again been the prime mover of the market, as Pakistan and India can only stare on in admiration. Turkey? Silencio again after a busy run that's now down to a trickle.

BANGLADESH

STUNNING HAUL AS MARKETS FALL!

Main market.

Bangladesh has been the market of the moment as Chattogram Choppers take in a stunning haul of vessels at the bidding tables this week, including three LNGs, and several handymax bulkers at the best market levels available at the moment, which also stand well above the regional competition and well ahead of expectations from the Chattogram market even in just the last week. After a barren few weeks at the empty bidding tables and near empty port reports on several occasions, the recent past and moreover, this week was compellingly more productive for the local market as MISC committed three more LNGs to local buyers as the PUTERI MUTIARA SATU (28,804 LDT), the PUTERI ZAMRUD SATU (28,858 LDT), and the PUTERI FIRU SATU (28,805 LDT) all were committed at over USD 11 million each, basis an 'as is' Malaysia delivery. In other sales, two handymax bulkers were committed to local buyers as the OCEAN AMAZING (7,075 LDT) was fixed for USD 300/LT LDT, also on an 'as is' Jakarta basis, but under tow. Finally, the WANTONG SUMMER (8,196 LDT) was finalized for an appreciably firm USD 443/LT LDT.

Barren recently.

And as ship owners and ship recyclers were just about fed-up with the overall state of the ship industry since 2022, Donnie delivered madness and surprising movements in the sub-continent that even helped local recyclers take delivery of a new 27K LDT LNG, despite an Ozempic anchorage this week. A thinning anchorage wasn't the only surprise awaiting local recyclers through the course of the week as Taka plummeted a massive 0.56% against the U.S. Dollar and ended the week at BDT 122.73. Local steel plate prices further tightened local margins by declining USD 4/Ton on their end and registered a still decent USD 502/ton.

Sales glut.

Economically however, the effects of war are starting to hit the nation as the local government has started rationing fuel delivery at local gas stations that is now leading to long lines and panic at the pumps. Schools, colleges, and universities have all been reportedly shut down for the time being. Fertilizer factories have ceased operations as electric load shedding (resulting in power losses) has become a regular cycle, on that's going to wreak havoc with incoming summer months. The effects on domestic ship recycling yards are reportedly even more dire as fuel quantities needed to operate yard machineries and motor-driven equipment have reduced operating hours. Local trucking delays in shifting recycled ship's steels out of yards has resulted in a 50% decline of output as trucking companies themselves are restricting their fleets from traveling longer distances. Inflation is back up on the rise as it wrapped February up at 9.13% (up from 8.58 in Jan). Seem only thing left when the monsoons arrive is for people to just stay home.

Just stay home?

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
PUTERI MUTIARA SATU	LNG	28,804	XS USD 11 MILLION 'as is' Malaysia
PUTERI ZAMRUD SATU	LNG	28,858	XS USD 11 MILLION 'as is' Malaysia
PUTERI FIRUS SATU	LNG	28,805	XS USD 11 MILLION 'as is' Malaysia
WANTONG SUMMER	Bulker	8,196	USD 443/LT LDT
OCEAN AMAZING	Bulker	7,075	USD 300/LT LDT ('as is' Jakarta under tow)

INDIA

LONG WALKS ON SHORT BRIDGES!

Losing green.

The Indian market remains price-positioned a long way away from its Bangladeshi competition (who unsurprisingly secured all of the sales of the week, including several Class NK-only HKC green units that are usually reserved for India), and is even behind its eager Pakistani counterparts for the last few weeks now. And unlike the competing regional economies in the ship-recycling space, India has generally weathered international storms and events with comparative ease, given, logically, its far greater economy.

Gas worries.

Yet, all is far from well, with a sprinkle of good news thrown into the mix. To start, the rumored shortage of fuel and gas availability that was supposed to hit the local market over the last couple of weeks has yet to surface, and will likely even fail to do so, given Trump is now attempting to back-pedal his brain from his own catastrophic, and inherently consequentially devoid, decision-making standards by lifting India's sanctions against Russian oil that should help India's rapidly rising inflation over recent months.

Prolonged shortage.

Speaking of which, inflation has now climbed from 0.25% in October to over 3.2% in March, highlighting probably the fastest pace of inflation, for better or for worse, over the last 11 months. And the performance of the Indian Rupee (which fell another 0.70%, down to Rs. 92.56 against the U.S. Dollar), along with local steel plate prices (which also fell a comparatively massive USD 10/Ton, down to USD 410/Ton), have likely been contributors to the degrading state of inflation and have also done little to help Alang's purchasing prowess, even though local anchorage has been far and away from facing as many near-empty reports as competing neighbors have during the same time.

Predicament.

And while the ease of completing an Alang re-delivery has historically helped this market see more tonnage come in than Bangladesh and Pakistan, the current state of Alang's pricing and the sudden improvements from Bangladesh this week, at a time when the world looks like it's on fire (just for fun), actually saw Alang-favored specialist units such as LNGs (rich in non-ferrous) likely heading to competing markets.

Long walks during short, trying times is certainly what seems to be Alang's current predicament.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

MORE THAN JUST THE MUSIC!

Empty handed.

Pakistan as a nation is facing up to more than just the music over the last few weeks as economically, politically, and from a ship-recycling standpoint, it's all gone a bit Willy Wonky. To start, on the international arena, Pakistani intelligence, ISI, is in a full public conflict against the Afghani Taliban, who it claims are being funded by India to engage in terrorism against Pakistan.

While that is ongoing, the U.S. and Israeli war against Iran is seeing some fallout in Pakistan, given that the nations are neighbors, and violent pro-Iranian factions in Pakistan have been targeting U.S. facilities in the country, with deaths being reported as a result.

Regional upheaval.

On the ship-recycling front, things continue a la Ozempic as another empty-handed week at the bidding tables for Gadani was instead spent witnessing all of the market tonnage heading to Chattogram shores, at rates far beyond the reach of offers tabled by the Gadani Gang, and despite demand still being ripe for the time being, having taken several larger LDT bulkers so far this year.

But like its sub-continent brethren, local fundamentals here remained in a pickle as, on the one hand, the Pakistani Rupee slid 0.48% and called it a week at a still-strong PKR 279.20 against the U.S.$, whilst local steel plate prices were the only rebels of the fundamentals as they climbed over USD 6.50/ton and wrapped things up at nearly USD 599/Ton – the highest margins of the industry. The logical cessation of inflow of steel scrap from Iran during these trying times will likely help this key fundamental deliver fair winds in the short term and help local pricing.

Demand good.

But with a war-riddled geographic region and an HKC development chart-sheet that's still teething at best, Gadani's waterfront will continue to see tonnage arrive in squirts every other month – and with the way 2025, and even 2024, has been for this market, it seems 2026 will likely be no different, especially as domestic inflation itself surged to 7% last month (up from 5.8% in January).

Like a handicapped father's unwitting dance at his daughter's wedding, Gadani's delivery schedule seems trapped in a similar fate.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STUGNATED?

Life support.

Stuck next to the warring nations and stagnated by degrading and dead fundamentals, Aliaga seems to be returning to vacation mode after what turned out to be one of the busiest starts to a year Aliaga has seen in recent times. Yet, making its presence felt week after week has been the U.S. Dollar, which has been painfully and consistently reminding Aliaga recyclers how much tighter their belts will continue to get as they hold on to their vessel prices in the face of a Lira that fell another 0.25% this week and wrapped things up at TRY 44.20.

If there is one thing that has remained consistent for Aliaga, it is just how fundamentals and international politics will be the ones to leave Aliaga's ship-recycling industry on life support before anything else does.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 11 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	435 / LDT	455 / LDT	465 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	415 / LDT	435 / LDT	445 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ARE THESE NEW?

- *Most people stroke cats the wrong way. Research shows they often just tolerate it for the food and attention. The safest spots? Under the chin, cheeks and base of the ears. The worst? Their belly and the base of their tail – touch there and you're more likely to annoy them than bond with them.*
- *A chicken once lived for 18 months without a head. Mike the chicken's incredible feat was recorded back in the 1940s in the USA. He survived as his jugular vein and most of his brainstem were left mostly intact, ensuring just enough brain function remained for survival. In the majority of cases, a headless chicken dies in a matter of minutes.*
- *The raw ingredients of a human body would cost over £116,000. But if you're prepared to do the refining yourself, a body could cost a lot less – under £100 in fact.*
- *All the world's bacteria stacked on top of each other would stretch for 10 billion light-years. Together, Earth's 0.001mm-long microbes could wrap around the Milky Way over 20,000 times.*
- *Wearing a tie can reduce blood flow to the brain by 7.5 per cent. A study in 2018 found that wearing a necktie can reduce the blood flow to your brain by up to 7.5 per cent, which can make you feel dizzy, nauseous and cause headaches. They can also increase the pressure in your eyes if on too tight and are great at carrying germs.*
- *The fear of long words is called Hippopotomonstrosesquippedaliophobia. The 36-letter word was first used by the Roman poet Horace in the first century BCE to criticise those writers with an unreasonable penchant for long words. It was American poet Aimee Nezheukumatathil, possibly afraid of their own surname, who coined the term how we know it in 2000.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 21 – Eid-ul-Fitr (subj. to Moon sighting) March 26 – Ram Navami March 31 – Mahavir Jayanthi	March 18 – March 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 19 – Eid-ul-Fitr March 20 – March 23 – Jumatul Bidah + Eid Day 2 & 3 March 26 – Independence Day	March 19 – March 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
March 21 – March 23 – Eid-ul-Fitr Days 1, 2, & 3	March 19 – March 23 - Eid-ul-Fitr & Ramzan Bayrami

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ALANG - Port Position as of March 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Antar	3,676	General Cargo	Arrived February 28
2	BuzanSkiy	1,760	Reefer Cargo	Arrived March 04
3	*Ghada A*	*2,240*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered March 06*
Morality		***7,675***		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of March 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Smooth Sea	1,816	Tanker	Arrived March 10
2	*Lima*	*26,915*	*LNG*	*Delivered March 08*
3	*Sirrah*	*7,072*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered March 08*
		35,803		

GADANI - Port Position as of March 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Atlas	2,573	General Cargo	Arrived February 26
2	Lumoso Permai	7,628	Bulk Carrier	Arrived March 09
3	*Xing Fa*	*2,300*	*Tanker*	*Delivered March 06*
Total Tonnage		***12,501***		

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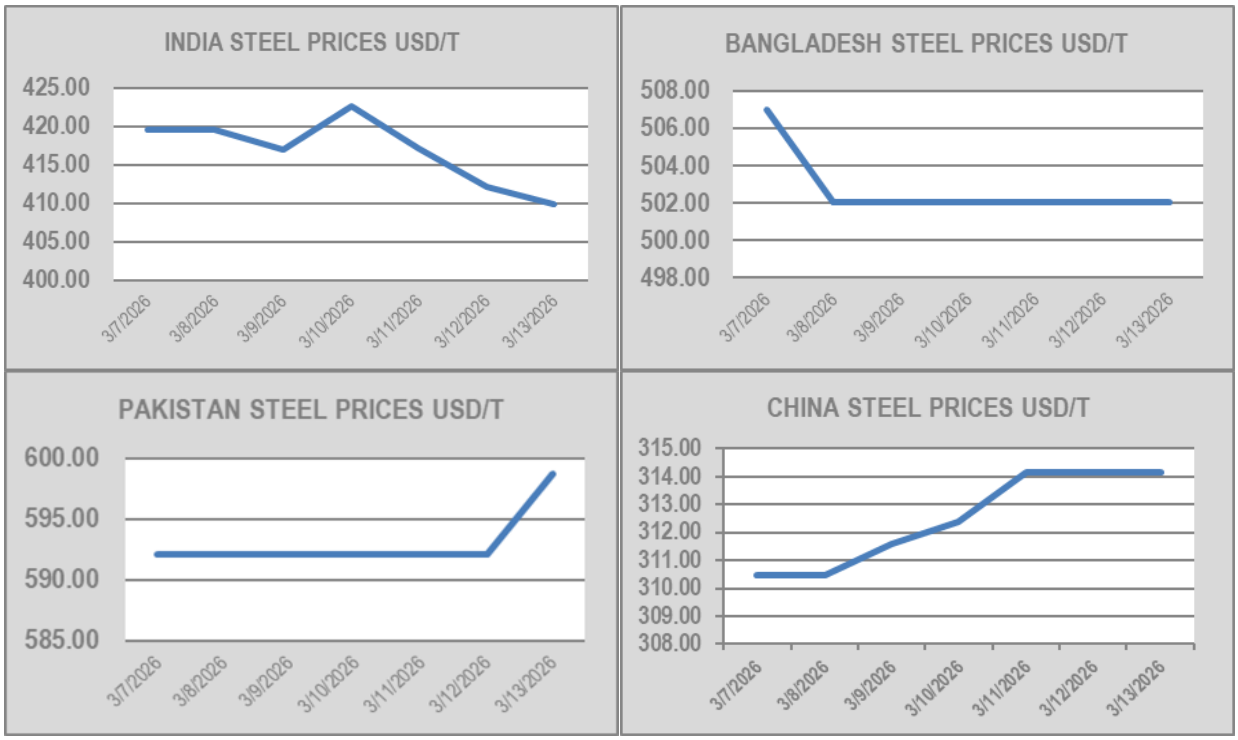
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/7/2026	419.62	38,500.00	592.12	166,000.00	506.98	61,700.00	310.47
3/8/2026	419.62	38,500.00	592.12	166,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	310.47
3/9/2026	416.94	38,500.00	592.12	166,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	311.60
3/10/2026	422.66	38,800.00	592.12	166,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	312.40
3/11/2026	417.21	38,400.00	592.12	166,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/12/2026	412.19	38,000.00	592.12	166,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/13/2026	409.95	37,900.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15



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